

FIXED-SCOPE WORKFORCE & TALENT SYSTEM DIAGNOSTIC

Workforce System Diagnostic

Find where the strategy is breaking between intent and execution.

Organizations can invest heavily in a workforce strategy, platform, framework, or rollout and still see little change in how decisions get made, how managers operate, or whether results improve.

The Workforce System Diagnostic helps senior leaders identify where the system is breaking, why the change is not taking hold, and what should be addressed first. It is built for workforce and talent transformations that have moved beyond strategy but are not yet changing operating practice consistently.

Where is the system actually breaking, and what should we fix first?

Designed For

The Diagnostic may be a fit when:

- Adoption or implementation is lagging despite significant investment
- New expectations have not changed day-to-day decisions or manager behavior
- Leaders disagree about whether the problem is ownership, capability, execution, or something else
- The organization knows results are off track but cannot confidently identify where the system is breaking down
- A workforce, skills-first, AI, mobility, planning, or talent-system initiative needs a clearer path from strategy to operating practice

Standard scope focuses on one defined initiative, function, business unit, or employer cohort so the diagnosis can go deep enough to be useful within a fixed 2–4 week window.

2–4 Weeks

ENGAGEMENT

6 Dimensions

SYSTEM LENS

Up to 10

STAKEHOLDER INTERVIEWS

\$30,000

FIXED FEE

What the Diagnostic Examines

Corework examines six parts of the infrastructure underneath execution. Each dimension tests whether the strategy has actually been translated into the roles, decisions, conditions, routines, and feedback loops required for it to hold.

01 Ownership

Who is accountable for system performance over time, and does that role have enough authority to act when performance deteriorates?

02 Capability Architecture

Has strategy been translated into current definitions of capability, work requirements, and evidence of effective performance?

03 Decision Architecture

Do decision rights, criteria, and evidence actually govern the decisions that determine hiring, mobility, development, performance, and investment?

04 Manager Operating Conditions

Do managers have the capacity, information, incentives, skill, role clarity, and leadership backing required to behave differently?

05 Operating Integration

Is the new model embedded in workflows, governance, funding, and routines strongly enough to survive pressure, transition, and competing priorities?

06 Measurement & Adaptation

Can the organization detect drift, distinguish activity from performance, and change the system when the evidence says it should?

What Corework Is Looking For

Across the six dimensions, the same failure often appears in different forms: the visible artifact still looks aligned with the strategy while operating reality has quietly drifted away from it.

The pattern can look like: → Ownership disconnected from authority → Capability definitions disconnected from current work → Criteria disconnected from actual decisions	And also: → Manager expectations disconnected from operating conditions → Adoption disconnected from operating integration → Reporting disconnected from sensing and adaptation
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The Diagnostic asks where the organization has confused the presence of a visible artifact with the existence of an operating system.

How the Diagnostic Works

The standard Diagnostic uses a defined evidence base that can be gathered reliably within a fixed engagement: agreed documents, targeted stakeholder interviews, and relevant system data. The work is designed to compare the official account with operating reality, not simply collect opinions.

Standard Evidence Base

Core Evidence

- Agreed documents, policies, role definitions, governance artifacts, and decision criteria
- Up to 10 targeted stakeholder interviews across formal owners and people who experience the system downstream
- Available system data, dashboards, workflow records, or usage data relevant to the live problem

How Evidence Is Tested

- Compare what is documented with what people actually do
- Use multiple sources to triangulate the same dimension rather than relying on one account
- State evidence limitations directly when access is incomplete

The Corework Diagnostic Method

01

Examine the System

Gather evidence against the six dimensions and test where stated strategy and operating reality match or diverge.

02

Locate the Breakpoints

Identify the points where ownership, capability, decisions, manager conditions, integration, or measurement are preventing the strategy from taking hold.

03

Prioritize What to Redesign

Determine which breakpoint most limits what the organization can accomplish elsewhere, so the roadmap is sequenced by leverage rather than by taxonomy order.

04

Build the Path Forward

Translate the diagnosis into practical near-term and mid-term actions, including a 30/60/90-day roadmap and the decisions leadership should make next.

Evidence Without False Precision

Corework does not reduce the Diagnostic to a single maturity score. Each dimension is assessed on its own evidence, and the report separates three things that are often blurred together:

- The finding itself, such as strong, mixed, or fragile, with a note where the evidence shows a disconnect between stated practice and operating reality
- The evidence gathered and the limits of that evidence
- A separate confidence level, so certainty is not overstated

What the Organization Receives

The goal is a defensible diagnosis that helps leaders decide where to act first, rather than a long list of disconnected observations.

Core Deliverables

- Executive summary with the dominant system diagnosis in plain language
- Decision-flow and system-breakpoint analysis
- Findings across all six dimensions, with evidence and confidence levels
- Cross-dimension synthesis identifying the breakpoint that most limits the rest of the system

Action Outputs

- Prioritized redesign opportunities, sequenced by leverage
- 30/60/90-day implementation roadmap
- Executive findings and action session with the leaders responsible for follow-through
- Evidence appendix showing what was reviewed and who was interviewed

The result is greater confidence about what is actually preventing the strategy from becoming operating practice, and where to act first.

How the Findings Are Synthesized

The Diagnostic is designed to produce one coherent explanation of the problem, not six separate report cards. Corework looks for compound patterns across dimensions, identifies the breakpoint that most constrains the rest of the system, and sequences the roadmap around what will unlock the greatest progress.

For example, stronger manager capability will not solve a problem if managers are still applying criteria that leadership does not enforce. Better measurement will not help if the data never reaches a forum with authority to act. The sequencing matters.

Where the Diagnostic Ends

The standard Diagnostic is intentionally fixed-scope. It is designed to identify the problem before the organization invests in a larger redesign effort. Higher-access methods, such as direct workflow observation, live decision review, extended case sampling, or implementation validation, can be used in a targeted redesign or implementation phase when the findings show they are needed.

This keeps the front-end engagement focused while preserving a clear path to deeper work when the evidence supports it.

Engagement Details

2–4 Weeks	1 Defined	Up to 10	1 Roadmap
FIXED-SCOPE	INITIATIVE OR UNIT	STAKEHOLDER INTERVIEWS	30 / 60 / 90 DAY

Standard Scope and Investment

OPTION	WHAT'S INCLUDED	TIMELINE	INVESTMENT
Standard Workforce System Diagnostic	One defined initiative, function, business unit, or employer cohort. Up to 10 stakeholder interviews, review of agreed documents and available system data, six-dimension findings, one report, 30/60/90-day roadmap, and one executive findings session.	2–4 weeks	\$30,000 fixed fee

Multi-unit, enterprise-wide, multi-geography, or data-intensive engagements are scoped separately.

What Is Included

- Sponsor kickoff and scope alignment
- Up to 10 targeted stakeholder interviews
- Review of agreed documents and available system data
- Six-dimension diagnosis and cross-dimension synthesis
- Executive report, 30/60/90-day roadmap, and findings session

What May Be Scoped Separately

- Multi-unit, enterprise-wide, or multi-geography scope
- Direct workflow observation or live decision review
- Extended case sampling or data analysis
- Targeted redesign and implementation support
- Ongoing advisory after the Diagnostic

WHAT IT IS NOT

This is not a survey, a training rollout, generic HR consulting, or a taxonomy exercise disconnected from real decisions. It is a diagnosis of the operating system underneath the strategy, built to determine what actually needs redesign before the organization invests further.

Something Should Be Working Better by Now?

Start with what you are seeing. A 30-minute fit conversation can confirm whether the Diagnostic is the right next move.

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